

Solstice optimizes thermal growing season

Figures

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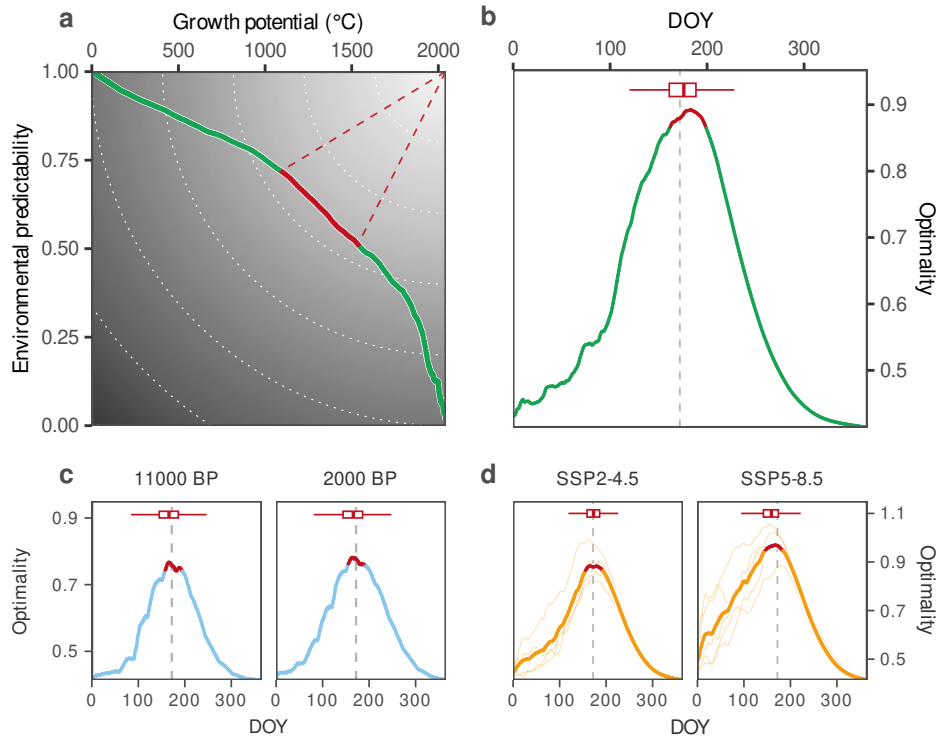


Figure 1: Solstice marks the average optimal trade-off between environmental predictability and growth potential across Europe. (a,b) represents current climatic conditions (1951-2020), (c) represents past climatic conditions (11000 BP and 2000 BP, where BP stand for "Before Present"), and (d) represents future climatic conditions (for two emission scenarios, SSP2-4.5 and SSP5-8.5). In (a), environmental predictability measures how well GDD by a given day predicts total yearly GDD (R^2 of a linear regression across years), while growth potential represents the remaining GDD from that day onward. In (b,c,d), optimality is based on the Euclidean distance from the (unattainable) perfect point where both predictability and growth potential are maximized (illustrated by the red dashed lines and the gray gradient in the left panel). The red sections of the curves represent days where optimality falls within the 90th percentile (i.e. top 10% most optimal days). GDD range was defined between 5°C and 35°C (see ?? for 0-40°C). BP stand for "Before Present" (i.e. 1950).

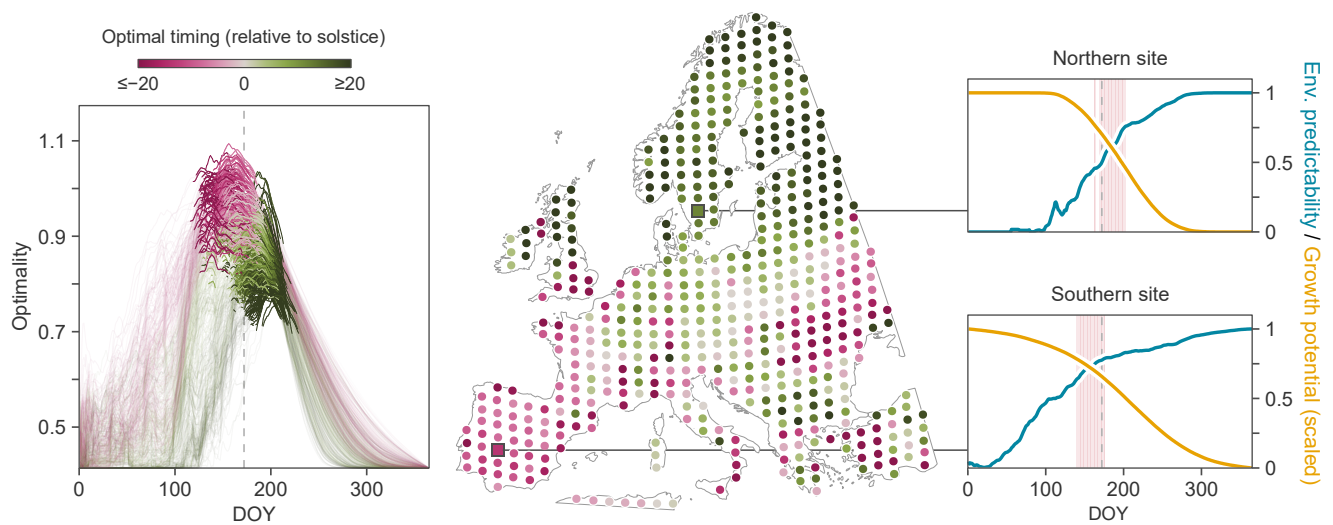


Figure 2: Average optimal timing (Figure 1) hides variation in optimal timing across the different climatic conditions of Europe (1951-2020). On the left panel, each curve shows the optimality for a given site. Sites are sampled on a regular grid across Europe, as shown on the central map. Colors indicate the timing—relative to the solstice—of the median optimal day. The two panels on the right show the trade-off between environmental predictability and growth potential (scaled to $[0, 1]$) for two different sites. Days considered as optimal are highlighted in red.